

Sunday, 4 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Partly cloudy

22° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

20° 10°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

18° 9°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

16° 11°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **A court has heard that a homemade bomb was part of an alleged plot targeting Manchester's Jewish community.**

Two men were arrested on the eve of Yom Kippur, a hugely important day in the Jewish calendar. This serious allegation highlights ongoing concerns about community safety.

CRIME · UK

- 2 **A man has been shot dead in west London while families were gathered for a memorial event.**

The 40-year-old sadly died at the scene from a gunshot wound. The Metropolitan Police are now investigating this shocking incident.

CRIME · UK

- 3 **The Conservative party has pledged to build 50,000 new prison places as part of their plans to cut crime.**

The party says these proposals would help stop prisoners being released early. It's a significant commitment ahead of their annual conference.

POLITICS · UK

- 4 **Energy suppliers are piling pressure on the government to take immediate action over rising energy bills.**

Trade body Energy UK says households need help this winter as they struggle with costs. It's a concern many people across the country share.

COST OF LIVING · UK

- 5 **Police are appealing directly to the mother of a baby girl found on a shoreline, urging her not to be afraid to call them.**

Officers are searching for the mother of the newborn, whose body was discovered recently. They've stressed their primary concern is her welfare.

POLICE APPEAL · UK

What's coming up

- 1 A film festival celebrating British-Latino identity is underway in London, showcasing a diverse range of cinematic talent.**

The festival will screen 60 films from 27 different countries over five days. It's a fantastic opportunity to explore new stories and cultures.

ON AIR – Are you planning to check out any of the films, or perhaps you've discovered a new favourite film festival recently?

FILM · THIS WEEK
- 2 A man from Malvern who watched 800 films during Covid has now gone on to direct them, working on a major TV series.**

Benjamin Williams has worked on Apple TV's 'Slow Horses' for its upcoming season. It just goes to show how unexpected passions can lead to exciting new careers!

ON AIR – Have you ever turned a lockdown hobby into something more? Perhaps you picked up a new skill that's now a big part of your life?

TV · COMING UP
- 3 The first batch of tickets for Glastonbury 2027 have already sold out in record time!**

Coach tickets for the iconic festival were snapped up in under 30 minutes. It seems anticipation for the next Glastonbury is already incredibly high.

ON AIR – Were you one of the lucky ones who managed to get a ticket, or are you hoping to snag one when the general sale opens?

MUSIC · 2027
- 4 An acoustic guitar played by Noel Gallagher at Oasis's famous 1996 MTV Unplugged gig has sold for a record price.**

The instrument fetched a huge sum at auction, highlighting its place in music history. It's a piece of rock and roll memorabilia that's clearly still highly sought after.

ON AIR – If you could own one piece of music memorabilia, what would it be and why?

MUSIC · AUCTION
- 5 After more than 10 years, Amelia Dimoldenberg has announced her popular YouTube series 'Chicken Shop Date' is shutting up shop.**

The show became a recipe for success, turning Amelia into a YouTube star. It's been a unique and much-loved format that will be missed.

ON AIR – What were some of your favourite 'Chicken Shop Date' moments, or which celebrity interview will you remember most?

YOUTUBE · ENDING

On the schedule

1 **An 'incredible' Red Bull upgrade has enlivened Formula 1 in Malaysia, with Lewis Hamilton now fearing Max Verstappen will be tough to beat.**

Verstappen took his first pole position of 2026 in Bahrain with an imperious performance. It looks like Sunday's Grand Prix could be a thrilling one!

ON AIR – Do you think anyone can challenge Verstappen this season, or is he set for another dominant year?

F1 · THIS WEEK

2 **Great Britain's Sonay Kartal has reached the last-32 at the China Open, setting up some exciting clashes in the tournament.**

Meanwhile, Alexander Zverev will face Novak Djokovic in a quarter-final clash in Beijing. It's shaping up to be a fascinating week of tennis.

ON AIR – Who are you backing to go all the way in the China Open, and what's been your highlight of the tennis season so far?

TENNIS · THIS WEEK

3 **Craig Bellamy says Wales' win over Norway has 'thrown a hand grenade' into their Nations League group ahead of their match against Denmark.**

Wales are now in search of another victory against Denmark in Cardiff on Sunday. It's set to be a crucial game for their Nations League hopes.

ON AIR – Do you think Wales can secure another win and make a real statement in their group this weekend?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Manchester United celebrated their 250th game in the club's history with a narrow victory over Liverpool in the Women's Super League.**

It was back-to-back wins for United, making it a special occasion for the club. Ella Toone reflected on a 'difficult week' but was pleased with the win.

ON AIR – What are your predictions for Manchester United in the WSL this season, and which teams do you think will be challenging for the title?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Louis Rees-Zammit scored a double as Bristol powered past reigning champions Northampton in a pulsating Prem rugby tussle.**

It was a strong performance from Bristol, securing a significant win against tough opposition. Rees-Zammit's form is certainly catching the eye.

ON AIR – Which player has impressed you most in the Premiership Rugby season so far, and which team do you think is looking strongest?

RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people embracing 'micro-adventures' closer to home.**
Instead of big holidays, folks are finding joy in short, local explorations like a wild swim at dawn or a night under the stars in their garden. It's all about making the most of what's on your doorstep!
- 2 The calming art of 'leaf pressing' is quietly making a comeback.**
It seems a lot of us are finding a lovely, mindful hobby in collecting autumn leaves and pressing them to preserve their vibrant colours. A delightful way to connect with nature.
- 3 Researchers are noting the surprising mood boost from 'spotting a perfectly symmetrical puddle'.**
There's a quiet satisfaction, apparently, in noticing those small moments of unexpected beauty. It's the little things that make us smile!
- 4 The humble 'hot water bottle' is being hailed as a wellness hero.**
Beyond just warmth, experts suggest the simple comfort of a hot water bottle can reduce stress and aid relaxation. A classic for a reason!
- 5 A charming movement encourages people to 'adopt a local park bench'.**
Volunteers are taking pride in keeping specific public benches clean and tidy, fostering a real sense of community spirit. What a lovely idea!
- 6 The simple joy of 'finding a coin face-up' is being celebrated.**
It's a small, unexpected bit of good luck that many admit can brighten their day. Every little helps, as they say!
- 7 A study highlights the 'comforting ritual of sorting buttons'.**
Apparently, the tactile nature and organisation involved in sorting through a button jar can be surprisingly therapeutic. Who knew buttons held such power?

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of tea, especially if it's a special blend. What is it?

ANSWER: WARMING THE TEACUP FIRST, EVEN IF IT'S JUST WITH A SPLASH OF HOT WATER.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of jam will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: SMELLING IT VERY INTENTLY, AS IF OUR NOSE IS A HIGHLY CALIBRATED JAM-O-METER.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular sound' just instantly transports you back to a specific memory or feeling, perhaps from your childhood or a happy holiday?
Like the distant chimes of an ice cream van, or the specific rumble of a train passing. What sound instantly takes you back, and where does it take you?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday act of kindness' that, when someone does it for you, truly makes your day, don't we?
Perhaps someone holding a door, or letting you go first in a queue. What's that small, thoughtful gesture that always brightens your day?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that some trees can 'talk' to each other, sending chemical signals through an underground fungal network to warn of insect attacks?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that if you hum while holding your nose, you can't actually hum because it blocks the air needed for the sound?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The world's smallest chameleon can fit on the tip of your finger.
- The 'king of fruits', the durian, is famed for its distinctive aroma, which some describe as a mix of cheese, onion, and gym socks.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still perfectly edible.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The British Isles are home to over 150 types of native trees and shrubs.
- The first orange carrots were bred in the Netherlands in the 17th century to honour the House of Orange.

On this day

Day 277 of the year, 88 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Amun; Christian feast day: Aurea of Paris; Christian feast day: Francis of Assisi Conclusion of Creationtide; Christian feast day: Blessed Francis Xavier Seelos. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1973 — M. Ward, American singer-songwriter
- 1948 — Duke Robillard, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1979 — Rachael Leigh Cook, American actress
- 1958 — Anneka Rice, Welsh radio and television host
- 1956 — Christoph Waltz, Austrian-German actor
- 1946 — Susan Sarandon, American actress and activist
- 1959 — Tony Meo, English snooker player
- 1979 — Caitríona Balfe, Irish actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1983 — Richard Noble sets a new land speed record of 633.468 miles per hour (1,019.468 km/h) at the Black Rock Desert in Nevada.
- 1958 — The current constitution of France is adopted.
- 2001 — Siberia Airlines Flight 1812 crashes after being struck by an errant Ukrainian missile. Seventy-eight people are killed.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1925 — Great Syrian Revolt: Rebels led by Fawzi al-Qawuqji capture Hama from the French Mandate of Syria.
- 2017 — Joint Nigerien-American Special Forces are ambushed by Islamic State militants outside the village of Tongo Tongo.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2004 — SpaceShipOne wins the Ansari X Prize for private spaceflight.
- 1993 — Battle of Mogadishu occurs killing 18 U.S. Special Forces, two UN Peacekeepers and at least 600 Somali militia men and civilians.

- 1920 — The Mannerheim League for Child Welfare, a Finnish non-governmental organization, is founded on the initiative of Sophie Mannerheim.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 278 of the year, 87 days left in 2026. Today World Space Week (October 4–10); Armed Forces Day (Indonesia); Christian feast day: Anna Schäffer; Christian feast day: Charitina of Amisus. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1985 — Brooke Valentine, American singer and songwriter
- 1950 — Jeff Conaway, American actor and singer (died 2011)
- 1984 — Naima Adedapo, American singer and dancer
- 1951 — Bob Geldof, Irish singer-songwriter and actor
- 1959 — Kelly Joe Phelps, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2022)
- 1957 — Bernie Mac, American actor, comedian, producer, and screenwriter (died 2008)
- 1948 — Russell Mael, American vocalist
- 1978 — James Valentine, American musician and songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1985 — Seven Israeli vacationers, including four children, are killed in a mass shooting at Ras Burqa in the Sinai Peninsula by an Egyptian soldier.
- 1943 — World War II: Pacific Theater: Ninety-eight American POWs are executed by Japanese forces on Wake Island.
- 1982 — Tylenol products are recalled after bottles in Chicago laced with cyanide cause seven deaths.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1990 — After 150 years The Herald newspaper in Melbourne, Australia, is published for the last time as a separate newspaper.
- 2000 — Mass demonstrations in Serbia force the resignation of Slobodan Milošević.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar